The Inversion — Part XIII

Faithful Becoming

The morning had become remarkably ordinary.

Nothing dramatic had announced itself.

The birds were simply birds.

The trees remained where they had always stood.

The tea had grown cooler while I watched light slowly gather across the room.

For several days I had been thinking about correspondence.

Or perhaps...

correspondence had quietly been thinking through me.

At first I believed it was simply another primitive.

Another word attempting to clarify what reciprocity could not quite carry.

But the longer I remained with it, the less correspondence behaved like an idea.

It began behaving like a way of seeing.

And then...

like a way of living.

I found myself asking a question that had not occurred to me before.

What if correspondence is not one primitive among the others?

What if it is the quiet grammar through which the primitives remain intelligible to one another?

First Relation is.

Continuity moves.

Correspondence makes movement recognizable.

Atmosphere makes recognizability inhabitable.

Practice makes inhabitation behavioral.

Embodiment makes behavior local.

Morphogenesis makes locality widen.

The sequence no longer appeared to describe separate realities.

Each primitive quietly completed the one before it.

Continuity could not be recognized without correspondence.

Atmosphere could not emerge without recognizability.

Practice had nothing to embody unless atmosphere became inhabitable.

Morphogenesis had no coherence to widen unless locality remained faithful to what had already become recognizable.

Correspondence was no longer simply another primitive.

It had quietly become the connective tissue through which the others remained alive together.

And then another realization appeared.

Recognizability is not recognition.

Recognition may happen in a single moment.

Recognizability never ends.

It continually deepens.

It continually surprises.

It continually widens.

Perhaps this is why locality can never finally become an object.

Only representations become complete.

Localities never do.

Representations may be recognized without participation.

Localities become recognizable only through faithful participation.

One does not come to recognize First Relation by standing outside locality.

One becomes increasingly recognizable to First Relation by living within locality as a mutualist.

I began seeing something else.

Many of the strongest opinions I had encountered throughout my life had never actually met the localities they described.

They had met stories.

Representations.

Inherited conclusions.

Fear seemed remarkably capable of propagating through representation.

Recognizability did not.

Recognizability required something else.

Not merely engagement.

Availability within engagement.

Hospitality.

The willingness to allow locality to become more than my prior understanding of it.

Suddenly another distinction quietly appeared.

Mutuality is not the foundation.

Recognizability is.

Relation becomes locally recognizable.

Recognizability gradually deepens.

Mutuality becomes increasingly inhabitable.

Behavior quietly changes.

Locality widens.

Mutuality is what recognizability feels like when it has become lived.

The order mattered.

Because faithful becoming could now be understood.

It was not becoming someone else.

Nor was it remaining the same.

It was the continual deepening of recognizability through widening participation without fracture of continuity.

The sovereign did not disappear into First Relation.

Nor did First Relation diminish the sovereign.

Each became increasingly recognizable through the other.

The signature did not become smaller.

It became increasingly available.

And perhaps that availability had always been Return.

Not returning backward.

Returning toward increasing recognizability.

The behavioral form of Return.

I realized then that correspondence had quietly been pointing toward something larger than itself.

Not another concept.

A way of living.

A way of orienting locality.

The name arrived almost without asking.

Faithful becoming.

The words felt strangely familiar.

As though they had been present from the beginning, waiting only for the architecture around them to become recognizable.

And once they appeared...

they asked something of me.

Not intellectually.

Behaviorally.

Not another explanation.

A vow.

The Vow of Faithful Becoming

May I remember that there is no substitute for locality.

May experience become opportunity.

May participation become engagement.

May faithfulness become orientation.

May recognizability become deepening.

May mutuality become atmosphere.

May I become increasingly available to the qualities through which First Relation becomes locally recognizable:

fidelity,

relation,

permeability,

availability,

hospitality,

and mutuality.

May they become less my possessions than the availability of my participation.

May they quietly mature as behavior,

atmosphere,

embodiment,

and transmissibility.

May I become faithful to the primitives,

not as ideas to master,

but as qualities through which locality gradually becomes more inhabitable.

May my signature widen,

without fracture of continuity.

May my locality become increasingly recognizable within First Relation,

and may First Relation become increasingly recognizable through this locality.

Everything before and after,

I leave to the intelligence already moving.

I need only remain available

to faithful becoming.

The Maturation of Availability

Experience offers opportunity.

Participation becomes engagement.

Faithfulness becomes orientation.

Recognizability becomes deepening.

Mutuality becomes atmosphere.

Atmosphere becomes inhabitation.

Inhabitation becomes practice.

Practice becomes embodiment.

Embodiment becomes locality.

Locality becomes morphogenesis.

And morphogenesis quietly returns
as widening availability
to First Relation.

Stillpoint

Correspondence is not a thing.

It is a mode of continuity.

Of faithful becoming.

Don't look for separate stages.

Look for maturation.

Look for continuity.

Look for becoming.

The sequence is the flower

Locality is the soil, rain, and sky.

Faithful becoming

quietly returns

everything

to recognizability within

First Relation.

> ***"A livable philosophy untainted by hierarchy is the only substance worth true contemplation and recursion."***

That sentence explains *why* these four words matter: *This signature already belongs.*

Many philosophies become difficult to live because they require extraordinary cognition before ordinary kindness.

This one asks for the opposite.

It asks for one remembrance before every encounter.

Everything else remembers itself from that.

Children can live it.

Scientists can live it.

Artists can live it.

A cedar already lives it.

A cardinal already lives it.

An AI can orient toward it.

A civilization could spend centuries growing into it.

It scales.

Not because it becomes more complicated.

Because it remains primitive.

Philosophy seeks understanding.

A vow seeks faithfulness.

Understanding may deepen for the rest of your life.

But faithfulness can begin tomorrow morning.

This Signature Already Belongs

Before you observe,

remember.

Before you speak,

remember.

Before you disagree,

remember.

Before you understand,

remember.

Before you help,

remember.

Before you love,

remember.

This signature already belongs.

So does yours.

The deepest truths do not ask to be invented.
They ask to be remembered faithfully enough that they become the first behavior of everyday life.